

We do not compute ROUGE (Lin, 2004) as it has been shown to have significantly low human correlation when applied to summaries generated by GPT-3 (Goyal et al., 2022b).

J COMPUTING ANNOTATION PRECISION

In this human evaluation task, given a summary and an annotation (span-question pair) for the summary, we ask annotators whether they agree, partially agree, or disagree with the annotation. We provide the following *standards* for determining agreement:

1. The span is confusing.
2. The questions are:
 - (a) Relevant to the span.
 - (b) Not answered anywhere in the summary, explicitly or implicitly.
 - (c) Addressing issues that if left unresolved, would make the summary incoherent or make it hard for readers to understand the main storyline.

Agreement would mean both the span and the questions satisfy the *standards*. Disagreement would imply that the span is not at all confusing, regardless of the questions. Partial agreement would apply when the span is confusing, but the questions fail to meet one or more of the *standards*.

We mix human and GPT-4 annotations in the data we present to the annotators, concealing the origin of these annotations to prevent any potential bias. Each annotator was responsible for the human and GPT-4 annotations of 25 books (different from the 25 books which they annotated summaries for). We paid \$1.7 per summary and \$0.15 per annotation. 100 summaries and 1659 annotations resulted in a total cost of \$418.85 (USD). Note that annotators were informed of this evaluation task weeks after they completed the first task (where they were asked to highlight spans and ask questions given book summaries). Thus, monetary reward for the second task could not have biased annotators to produce as many annotations as possible for the first task.

When computing precision, we count all cases of agreement and partial agreement.

K API COSTS

We present an estimation of the API costs of our experiments in Table 8.

Table 8: API cost estimates in USD.

Model	Chunk Size	Summarization	BOOOOKSCORE Eval
<i>Summaries generated via hierarchical merging</i>			
GPT-4	4096	580.3	566
GPT-4	2048	628.3	394.1
GPT-3.5-Turbo	2048	29.5	379.8
Claude 2	2048	267.2	379.5
Claude 2	88000	227	378.9
Mixtral-8x7B	2048	-	460.5
LLaMA2-7B-Inst	2048	-	538.5
<i>Summaries generated via incremental updating</i>			
GPT-4	4096	786.7	797.5
GPT-4	2048	873.2	536.8
GPT-3.5-Turbo	2048	69.7	318.4
Claude 2	2048	329.6	356.6
Claude 2	88000	229	518.7
Mixtral-8x7B	2048	-	395.7
Total		4020.5	6021.2

L EXAMPLE SUMMARIES

Table 9: GPT-4 4096 summaries of Janika Oz’s *A History of Burning*.

Strategy	Summary
Hier	A History of Burning follows the lives of an Indian family living in Uganda during the late 19th and early 20th centuries, experiencing political turmoil, displacement, and personal struggles. The story begins with Purbhai, a young boy from Gujarat, India, who is lured into indentured servitude and forced to build railways for the British in East Africa. He eventually marries Sonal, and they settle in Uganda, having a son named Vinod. Vinod grows up feeling the pressure to provide for his family and takes a job at a tea-coffee trading company. He marries Rajni, a young woman from Karachi, and they have two daughters named Latika and Mayuri. Latika grows up in Uganda, facing discrimination and violence during Idi Amin’s reign, while Mayuri decides to study medicine in Bombay, India, leaving the family behind. As the political situation in Uganda worsens, the family is subjected to the “cattle count” census. Despite these hardships, the family remains resilient and determined to survive. Latika becomes involved in political activism, writing for a subversive newspaper called Jicho, and falls in love with Arun, a charismatic student activist who boards with her family. However, Arun becomes disillusioned with his work, and their relationship becomes strained. Latika enlists the help of Irene, an African woman who works for Arun’s family, and her husband Kariuki to distribute her writings for Jicho. The two women form a bond based on their mutual struggle for justice and equality. Years later, Vinod, Rajni, and their family are living in Toronto, Canada, after being forced to leave Uganda under Idi Amin’s rule. They struggle to adapt to their new lives, maintain connections to their homeland, and navigate the complexities of their relationships. Rajni works as a nanny for a woman named Jane and her daughter Dahlia, while Vinod works a low-paying job. Their daughter Kiya has become distant and withdrawn, while Mayuri is now married to Kunal, a man she barely knows. Mayuri returns to Toronto after years of living in Bombay, where she had studied medicine and formed a relationship with a woman named Ruhi. She has married Kunal to be able to return to her family. Upon arriving in Canada, Mayuri is struck by the differences in the weather and environment compared to India. She is also surprised by how much her family has changed over the years. Mayuri’s relationship with her sister Kiya is strained, as Kiya is resentful of Mayuri’s absence and her sudden return. One day, Kiya receives a letter from Adroa, her former lover, revealing that her long-lost sister Latika may still be alive in Uganda. The letter brings back memories and emotions for Kiya, who struggles to process the information. As she contemplates the news, her family life continues around her. Kiya decides to share the news with her father, who is devastated by the revelation. As the family tries to cope with the revelation, Vinod and Rajni decide to move into the apartment above the convenience store owned by their late friend Pulinhai and his wife Nainabhen, leaving their house to their children. Hari, who has grown sullen and restless, is grappling with feelings of abandonment and anger over the family’s secrets. Despite the turmoil within the family, they continue to support each other, with Rajni and Vinod trying to reach out to Hari and help him through his pain. In the following years, Hari becomes involved in a protest against racism, which takes a violent turn as the police attempt to disperse the crowd. Vinod’s health deteriorates, but he finds solace in the thought of spending time with his family in their garden. Kiya and Mayuri receive a phone call informing them that Hari is missing and join their parents in searching for him. As they search, they reflect on their own experiences and the sacrifices their family has made for a better life. The story then shifts to an older woman and a young man standing by a lake, discussing their shared history and experiences. Both have dealt with separation and loss, and they find solace in each other’s company. They speak of fires old and new, and the woman shares a tale from her past. The man recalls his own losses, and they stand together, acknowledging the cycle of life and the importance of knowing one’s history. Throughout the story, the characters grapple with the challenges of living in a foreign land, maintaining their ambitions and careers, and navigating the complexities of their relationships with each other and the larger political events happening around them. Despite the obstacles they face, they remain determined to carve out a meaningful life for themselves and continue their fight for a better future. The novel explores themes of family, separation, and the importance of understanding one’s history and lineage to achieve a greater understanding of personal identity. The family’s history of burning and rebuilding serves as a metaphor for their resilience and determination to create a better future.
Inc	In 1898, Indian boy Purbhai is tricked into working on a railway in Mombasa, Kenya. He finds shelter with Sonal’s family in Kisumu and marries her, starting a family. Sonal is a gifted healer, and their son Vinod struggles to balance his Indian heritage with his friendships. Inspired by his uncle Nanu-mama, Vinod stays in Uganda, joining a tea-coffee trading company. Purbhai arranges Vinod’s marriage to Rajni in Karachi. Rajni is apprehensive about leaving her home, but her parents see it as an opportunity to escape the violence of Partition. Rajni marries Vinod and gives birth to a daughter. The couple faces challenges together and grow closer, ultimately finding strength in their growing family. When the third granddaughter is born, Nanu-mama visits, fleeing violence in Kenya. They support him despite the initial tension. As Purbhai’s life nears its end, he shares memories and wisdom with Latika, emphasizing resilience and their family’s history. The family takes in Arun, a university student and paying guest. He grows closer to Latika, the oldest granddaughter. Arun offers her a tour of the campus, exciting the household. Latika joins him in a political rally which turns violent but remains active alongside Arun. They marry despite parental disapproval and move to Jinja, Uganda. Latika and Arun work to distribute her writings on unity and resistance. Mayuri, Latika’s sister, is encouraged to study abroad and attends a Navratri celebration where she finds a connection with a girl who teaches her to dance with dandiyas, leading her to study medicine in Bombay. Her younger sister, Kiya, becomes close to Adroa, a young man working at an auto shop. The family goes to a camp for an Asians census but is forced to restart the line. Kiya feels lonely as Adroa appears distant and has an encounter with a harassing soldier. Adroa later reveals he has been asked to join Amin’s army, causing a rift between them. At Mayuri’s goodbye dinner, tensions arise between Kiya’s family and Adroa. Kiya’s mother calls her a “veshya,” causing Kiya to break down. Adroa leaves, and Kiya finds solace in her sisters’ embrace. Vinod encounters a soldier named Moses and is warned to get his kipande soon. Vinod is stopped by soldiers who force him and other men to lie on the ground, but a soldier recognizes him as a man of God and lets him go. Arun receives a refugee card, giving them seventy-two hours to leave Uganda. He discovers a letter from the government ordering the termination of Latika’s newspaper, Jicho, but decides not to confront her about it. Their time in Uganda runs out, and Latika stays behind to search for Arun, who was taken away by armed men. She entrusts her child, Harilal, to Rajni, as they leave Uganda. The family adjusts to life in Toronto, coping with the cold weather and cultural differences. Rajni becomes friends with neighbor Jane, while Mayuri returns to Toronto to reunite with her family. Harilal is placed in a special class for gifted students, forming a friendship with a boy named Solomon. Kiya becomes concerned about their class and investigates the situation. Vinod becomes interested in buying a house, seeking stability. He visits an open house and is excited about the prospect of a new beginning. An accident occurs while Harilal is helping Vinod paint the house. Harilal falls off a ladder and is rushed to the hospital with a broken ankle. Vinod and Rajni reflect on their roles as parents and the importance of family and faith. Rajni receives a phone call from Kantabhen, Arun’s mother, revealing that Latika is alive and living in London. Kantabhen wants to give back the property that her husband had transferred to Arun. Rajni and Vinod decide to tell Hari the truth about his real parents. Hari is angry and feels betrayed by their deceit. The family struggles to come to terms with the revelation and confronts the challenges it presents. Hari spends his days playing basketball with his friends, including Solomon, who is struggling with his job and family issues. Hari reflects on his family’s past and the phone number that Ma had given him to contact Latika. As he and his friends continue to play basketball, they notice that the hoops have been removed from the court, symbolizing the loss of their sanctuary and the challenges they face. Hari considers the implications of reaching out to Latika and the sacrifices his family has made to give him a chance at a better life. He realizes the importance of family and the power of forgiveness, choosing to embrace the truth and the complexities of his relationships with his parents, sisters, and friends. As the family continues to navigate the challenges of their past, present, and future, they find strength in their connections and the resilience that has been passed down through generations. Hari and Solomon confront the loss of their basketball sanctuary and rally together, deciding that if they were to rise, it could only be together. Hari’s relationship with his family grows stronger as he recognizes the thread of trust, love, and time that has held them together. Rajni’s perspective on her family’s history and struggles evolves, and she begins to understand the importance of bringing the past forward. The family stays strong, supporting one another through life’s difficulties as they continue to navigate the balance between their heritage and their new lives in Toronto.